

cheaper, lighter and compact tripods are usually made of plastic with a bit of metal framework. They aren't among the strongest, but they are great for casual photographers and professional who need to carry tripods for long distances in their bags. There are also tripods with flexible stands and compact stands called monopods. These a single-foot stand that is used to stabilise the camera.

Setting up a camera and a tripod are simple. First, extend the feet of the tripod to the height you want to place the camera on. Use locks on the feet to stop the tripod from retracting to its original form. If your tripod has a detachable mount, remove it and rotate the base to fit the camera. Next, simply latch the base mount back to the tripod in the right direction.

To set the camera, tripods come with a built in spirit levels. Some tripods, have two spirit levels for stability across all four directions.



Monopod is a portable accessory to get for your camera

10.2 Filters

Filters are basically add-ons that fit over your camera lens and are used to enhance the camera's capabilities. Clear lens filters are used to protect the camera lens from dust and dirt. Lens filters are also used to alter the colour and tint of the image captured.

There are many other kinds of filters. UV Filters and Polarizers are two of the well known ones. UV filters are used to cut out or reduce ultraviolet light. They are usually used to reduce hazy results. Polarizers help in darkening images. Contrast and saturation are usually increased with the use of polarizer filters. Diffusion filters are used to soften the look of photos. Filters are also available for a few point-and-shoot cameras, but they are limited to mostly colour tint changing and for protecting the lens.

The advantages of using filters are obvious but many believe that they also deteriorate quality can cause image warping.